

Accountability Without Self-Punishment

40 min · November Week 4

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish accountability (honest reckoning that produces repair) from self-punishment (shame-based suffering that produces nothing), and apply the Friend Test to a real situation.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: emotional regulation and accountability · Self-Awareness: accountability-punishment distinction
SCENARIO CARDS	Friend Test Scenario Cards — concrete school situations (Card 1 & Card 2)
QUICK REVIEW	1–2 min: "We have been building the Compassionate Witness. Today its most practical application: what do you do when you actually make a mistake? What is the difference between holding yourself accountable and punishing yourself?"

LEGAL · PPRA NOTE

PPRA Designation — All standard opt-out protocols apply. This lesson includes the Accountability vs. Self-Punishment Reflection — PPRA-designated activity. All standard opt-out protocols apply. Students who describe patterns of severe self-punishment in response to minor mistakes are at higher risk. Note privately for counselor awareness before U2L6.

ANCHOR CHART · ACCOUNTABILITY VS. SELF-PUNISHMENT — TWO-COLUMN CHART

Draw this **before class**. Add the four-step accountability structure in Step 2. **ACCOUNTABILITY:** "I made a choice that did not fit who I want to be. What do I need to do?" → Forward motion → produces repair. **SELF-PUNISHMENT:** "I am bad. I will suffer." → Focuses on self → produces nothing useful. Key insight: "**Feeling bad is not the same as taking responsibility. Action is.**"

OPENING · 3 MINUTES

"When you make a mistake, how long do you typically spend feeling bad about it versus actually fixing it? Today we look at the difference between holding yourself accountable — which produces something — and punishing yourself, which usually produces nothing."